

Personal appearance and appearances via ZOOM are available.

UPDATED at 11:45 a.m. Probate Calendar for Friday, July 17, 2026
9:00 a.m. in Department Paso 2, with Judge Michael C. Kelley presiding

No.	Case Number	Case Name	Type of Matter	Probate Notes
<u>The following matters are OFF CALENDAR/ DISMISSED/ TERMINATED or CONTINUED:</u>				
2	14PR-0274	Guardianship of: Brianna Spicer	Petition Third & Final Account Filed 10/31/2025	CONTINUED LIST: <i>The matter is continued to October 23, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. All additional information must be filed by September 18, 2026. The following is noted:</i> 1. <i>Ending balance on Hand.</i> a. <i>Additional information is needed as to how some of the share amounts were calculated. The Court is unable to duplicate the shares owned based on the information provided for CAIBX, ABALX, AMECX, AIVSX. The Raymond James account share values on the Change In Form assets schedule are not isolated per fund. The Petitioner should reorganize and check all of the share values on those six stocks. Please see the Fiduciary Accounting Handbook (CEB), Auxiliary Schedules, section 12.19.1 Form: Purchase of Bond and Reimbursement of Dividend for a sample of how to show the running total of the stock shares owned.</i> 2. <i>Further review will be needed once the above issues are resolved.</i>

3	20PR-0014	Conservatorship of: John Lindquist	Petition Second Account & Report Filed 11/07/2025	CONTINUED LIST: <i>A declaration was filed on July 8th, indicating a continuance was needed due to a significant error found and an Amended Account would be needed. The Declaration did not provide a proposed timeline. A continuance is recommended for 90 days, to December 11, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. The Amended Second Account or an explanation explaining the situation and how much time is needed must be filed by November 13, 2026.</i>
8	22PR-0103	Guardianship of: Natalie Seybold	Petition Third Account Filed 1/08/2026	CONTINUED LIST: <i>The matter is continued to January 8, 2027 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. All additional information is due by December 11, 2026. The following is noted:</i> <i>1. A GC-400 (SUM) Summary of Account form has <u>not</u> been provided. This is a mandatory form. Based on the Court's calculations, the Charges (Assets on hand, receipts, gains) do not currently match the Credits (Disbursements, loss, plus assets on hand ending value). The Change in the Form of Asset Schedule found in the middle of the account schedules is an Auxiliary Schedule and was not included in balancing the Account. Please review Probate Code sections 1060-1063 for the accounting requirements. The account is off balance by \$14,428.94.</i> <i>2. Bond. Proof of the reduction in bond from the last order is needed to confirm how much additional bond is needed. The last bond filed is for \$316,800. Bond was supposed to be reduced to \$258,485.45 per the last Court order. Proof of the reduction of \$58,314.55 is still needed. With this Account, bond should be set at \$275,000, which, if starting at the \$258,485.45, should only require an additional bond of \$16,514.55. The petition appears to believe a lesser bond is in place. Clarification is needed.</i> <i>3. A Proposed Order is needed.</i> <i>4. The Court Account review fee of \$305 is due.</i>

				<i>An OSC re Final Account is set for January 8, 2027 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. The period of the Fourth and Final Account shall cover from November 1, 2023 to October 11, 2026 or the date the funds are turned over to the former minor, whichever is later.</i>
9	22PR-0179	Guardianship of: Shania Jefferies	Petition First Account Filed 1/09/2026	CONTINUED LIST: <i>The matter is continued to December 4, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. All additional materials are due by November 5, 2026. The following is noted:</i> <i>1. Proof of service of Notice of Hearing on the minor has not been located. The proof of service filed July 1, 2026 did not provide notice to the minor, who is almost 18.</i> <i>2. Confidential supporting Financial Institution Statements are needed. (Prob. Code § 2620.)</i> <i>3. A fully amended Account is needed due to the type of issues discussed below. The account does not appear to balance due to the inclusion of unrealized gains and losses in the receipts and the incorrect starting balance.</i> <i>4. The Account Period does not cover the full period, from the time of the temporary guardianship being ordered on June 3, 2022.</i> <i>5. Assets on Hand.</i> <i>a. The starting balance on the Account does not match the Inventory Value of \$24,028.56. This was allegedly the June 3, 2022 values, which is the date the temporary guardianship of the estate was approved.</i> <i>b. The Coins and bonds need to be itemized on the accounting schedule, to match the Inventory list. The values should match the Inventory and Appraisal.</i> <i>6. Receipts. See Probate Code section 1060-1064.</i> <i>a. Transfers between bank accounts should not be reported as receipts. Only new funds received by the estate should be reported.</i>

				<i>Were the Mechanics Bank accounts ending in 2544 and 4060 transfers from another bank account already included on the inventory and appraisal? Or are they new funds received by the estate? If they represent new funds, what was the source of that \$950.00 and \$2,622.00?</i> <i>b. Changes in the form of assets, including unrealized gains and losses on investment accounts are not reported in Probate Accountings. Please see the CEB Fiduciary Accounting Handbook. The \$1,822.11 should not have been reported in the account. Market value, for information only, appears on Schedule E with the Carry Value.</i> <i>7. Disbursements.</i> <i>a. The \$500 a month in living expenses needs to be described with particularity. How exactly were these funds used to support the minor? Rent? Utilities? Health insurance? Food? A detailed breakdown for each month is needed. See Probate Code section 1060.</i> <i>8. Assets on Hand at End. The end of the Account should reflect the itemized assets. The bonds and coins should be listed.</i> <i>9. A proposed Order is needed.</i> <i>10. The Court Account Review fee of \$305 is due.</i> <i>11. The bond is recommended to remain in place until resolution of the accounts is completed.</i>
10	22PR-0179	Guardianship of: Shania Jefferies	Petition Second Account Filed 1/09/2026	CONTINUED LIST: <i>The matter is continued to December 4, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. All additional materials are due by November 5, 2026. A fully Amended Account may be needed due to the errors in the First Account, for which this account is reliant. The following is noted:</i>

				1. <i>Proof of service of Notice of Hearing was not located on the minor.</i> 2. <i>Confidential supporting Financial Institution Statements are needed. (Prob. Code § 2620.)</i> 3. <i>Assets on Hand.</i> a. <i>The coins and bonds need to be itemized on the accounting schedule to match the list. The values should match the Inventory and Appraisal.</i> 4. <i>Receipts. See Probate Code section 1060-1064.</i> a. <i>Changes in the form of assets, including unrealized gains and losses on investment accounts (market fluctuations) or transfers between accounts, are not reported in Probate Accountings. Please see the CEB Fiduciary Accounting Handbook. The \$3,824.02 should not have been reported in the account. Market value, for information only, appears on Schedule E with the Carry Value.</i> 5. <i>Disbursements.</i> a. <i>The \$500 a month in living expenses needs to be described with particularity. How exactly were these funds used to support the minor each specific month? Rent? Utilities? Health insurance? Food? A detailed breakdown for each month is needed. See Probate Code section 1060.</i> 6. <i>Assets on Hand at End. The end of the Account should reflect the itemized assets remaining. The bonds and coins should be listed with particularity.</i> 7. <i>A proposed Order is needed.</i> 8. <i>The Third and Final Account is due for the period of August 21, 2025 to the date the assets are turned over to the minor, who turns 18 on August 18, 2026. An OSC re: Third and Final Account is</i>
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				<i>recommended to be set on Dec. 4, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2 with the other two settings.</i>
11	23PR-0364	Conservatorship of: Nona Crist	Petition First & Final Account Filed 1/07/2026	CONTINUED LIST: <i>The matter is continued to October 23, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. All additional information is due by September 18, 2026. The following is noted:</i> <i>1. The Account period is incorrect. The account must cover the date of appointment, which was June 14, 2024 (Court appointment and date of I&A appraisal) to the date of death. A second Account, for the period for the date after death to present time may be filed with the Petition.</i> <i>2. Confidential financial statements were not provided to support the account (Prob. Code §2620.) The documents provided do not support the beginning of the account, nor the ending date of the account cited. All of the statements are from May 2026. It is also difficult to determine what exists because the account is missing an asset on hand schedule for the end of the account. The total on the statements is \$343,472.17, which does not match the alleged ending balance.</i> <i>3. Confidential care facility statements were not provided to support the account (Prob. Code, §2620.)</i> <i>4. An Amended Account appears necessary. The current account is off balance due to the error in the starting value. In addition, the credits do not currently match the charges, even in the format filed with the Court.</i> <i>5. Assets on Hand at Beginning of Account. The starting balance does not match the inventory and appraisal value. This appears to be due to the incorrect starting date.</i> <i>6. Receipts Missing. Due to the incorrect starting date, there appear to be receipts that have not been reported.</i>

				7. <i>Unusual Receipts. The large Social Security payments in early 2035 require further information.</i> 8. <i>Disbursements.</i> a. <i>The care facility payments were not properly listed. The payments should be listed by date and payment, not lumped into one entry. Each payment, identified by each invoice, must be provided. (See Probate Code sections 1060-1061.)</i> b. <i>Additional itemization is needed on the \$1,333 in costs paid to the attorney on or around 12/12/24.</i> c. <i>What is the \$66.00 “transportation to dental”? Is this a Uber? Is this Petitioner’s gas mileage request?</i> d. <i>The payments for health insurance need to be itemized by date and payment. Lumping the payments together in a 18 month stretch of time does not comply with Probate Code section 1060-1061 or allow any meaningful review of the expenses. The payment for supplies need to have the payee, and date, as well as being itemized.</i> e. <i>The reimbursements to the Petitioner, totaling \$38,095.77 need to be supported by receipts. It is unclear how a HELOC was taken out, as the conservatorship has no real property. Itemization and receipts are needed for all items paid to the Petitioner without prior Court approval. For sums paid prior to the conservatorship being established, additional information is needed on why each item was needed and why the conservatee was not paying for these items prior to the establishment of the conservatorship.</i>
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				9. <i>Assets on Hand. An asset on Hand for the end of the Account has not been provided.</i> 10. <i>The Court Account fee of \$305 is due.</i> 11. <i>Bond is recommended to remain in place until the Court is able to resolve this account and confirm transfer to the proper location.</i> 12. <i>Explanation is needed on what happened to the \$339,908.73 in assets allegedly on hand per the Summary of Account item 13.a. (NO asset on Hand Schedule provided as noted above). The prayer of the Petition requests “the balance of the assets of the conservatorship be held in the existing bank account until further order pertaining to disposition of the assets through Conservatee’s estate and upon that transfer, conservator is discharged....” It is unclear what this means. What is being proposed? A probate Estate appears necessary based on the estate value. The Court could not find record of one being opened, but it appears Petitioner already starting to reimburse herself for estate expenses using conservatorship assets.</i>
13	PR24686	Conservatorship Of: Michael Santos	Petition Fourteenth Account & Report Filed 11/19/2025	<i>CONTINUED LIST: The matter is continued to December 11, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. All additional materials are due by November 6, 2026. The following is noted:</i> 1. <i>Receipts. What are the two payments titled “Miscellaneous” Interest Income, of \$6,026.94?</i> 2. <i>Disbursements- Credit Card Payments.</i> a. <i>Additional information is needed on the monthly payments of \$26.90 each month for Heating and Air repair at various companies (24 months=\$645.60), along with other entries in December 2022, for \$1,266.00, and April 2024 of over \$1,000 for appliance repair (Paso</i>

				<i>Robles Heating and Air \$624.34 and Bee Right There Heating and Air \$446.00).</i> <i>b. What are the \$72.99 credit card fees on 8/4/23 regarding?</i> <i>c. Why are there donations of the conservatorship assets? \$60.90 and \$33.71 to North County Christian. Citation to the order allowing donations of conservatorship assets are needed.</i> <i>d. What are "home supplies" from Amazon, Home Depot, and Idlers. These charges exceed \$2,000 in the credit card report, but does not provide clear information as to what was purchased. This appears to be separate from diapers, wipes, electronics and clothing.</i> <i>e. Additional information is needed on the chickens. The costs associated with the chickens is not clearly a benefit to the conservatee. Explanation is needed.</i> <i>3. Schedule F- Change in the form of assets from cash to home improvements.</i> <i>a. Itemized invoices are needed, explaining the amounts spent on the 6 categories of home improvements listed in the Petition, the new washing machine and the AC repairs. These items are all reported on Schedule F, as payments to James Pahler Construction, with little details as to what exactly each improvement cost. As \$163,961 in funds spent, additional information is needed as to the exact amounts spent on each</i>
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				<i>category and how the Petitioner determined the prices for each service was appropriate. The Court is unable to evaluate the need and propriety of such a large investment without these itemized details. In the future, it is recommended the Court disallow home improvements during an account period, over \$5,000 for a twenty-four-month period, without prior Court approval.</i> <i>b. Why is the removal of a dead tree listed as an improvement to the real property, and not just a disbursement?</i> <i>4. A proposed order is needed.</i> <i>5. The Court Account Review fee of \$305 is needed.</i> <i>6. The 15th Account and Report, for the period of January 1, 2025 to December 31, 2026 is due by March 1, 2027.</i>
<u>APPROVED LIST</u>				
1	14PR-0082	In Re: Barbara Linda Ware Special Needs Trust	Petition Fifth Account Filed 12/04/2025	APPROVED LIST: <i>The matter is recommended for approval, subject to the following:</i> <i>1. The total bond of \$123,700 is recommended. Bond is currently set and posted at \$116,307.35. This results in a bond increase of \$7,392.65. An OSC re: Increased bond is set for October 30, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2.</i> <i>2. The Court Account review fee of \$305.00 is due.</i> <i>3. The Sixth Account, for the period of October 1 2025 to September 30, 2027 is due by January 5, 2028.</i>
7	21PR-0074	Conservatorship of: Richard Ratledge	Petition Fourth Account & Report Filed 12/24/2025	APPROVED LIST: <i>The matter is approved, subject to the following modifications:</i>

				1. Now that the conservatee is renting the entire residence, per the Petition, it is recommended the items in the storage unit be moved to that location to eliminate the storage costs of \$486 a month. The Petition indicates the Petitioner will be trying to downsize the items, so it is recommended the items also be relocated to end the storage costs. 2. Assets on Hand. The assets held in the Edward Jones Account need to be listed with specificity. It appears there are a number of certificate of deposit accounts, five in total, that should have been listed, in addition to the cash deposit account(s). The main bank account, with the basic deposit cash accounts (five total) may be listed as currently shown. A revised Assets on Hand for the end of the account period is required as part of the approval. 3. The \$305 Account Review fee is due. 4. Bond. The Current bond in place is \$1,813,000.00. The requested increase of \$230,000 is recommended, for a total bond of \$2,043,000. An OSC re: Increased bond is set for October 23, 2026 at 9:00 a.m. in P2. 5. The Fifth Account and Report for the period of October 1, 2025 to September 30, 2027 is due by January 7, 2028.
12	24PR-0164	Conservatorship of: Andrea Kern	Petition First & Final Account Filed 12/01/2025	APPROVED LIST: *UPDATE* The matter is recommended for approval. A copy of a receipt showing transfer to the conservatee of the personal property as alleged in paragraph 5 and a proposed order are pending in e-file as of 11:18 a.m. on July 16 th .

14	PR050143	Conservatorship of: Maria Gutierrez	Petition re: Ninth Account Filed 8/01/2025; Cont'd 3/13/26	APPROVED LIST: <i>The matter is recommended for approval, as Amended by the Amended 9th Account, subject to the following additional orders:</i> 1. <i>The Amended Account contains a typo in the Summary of Account presented. The Credits total \$86,983.86, not the \$75,909.07 written. It appears that Petitioner has incorrectly listed a number on item 13.c. of the Summary of Account. The value for 13.c. should have been 13.a. plus 13.b., or \$32,467.53. This number, plus \$43,491.93 (disbursements), less \$50.42 in "adjustments" that are not explained, equals \$75,909.07. Note, although there should be no adjustments in the account, the error appears to be harmless and no action is recommended. The accounts should balance in the future without the use of any "adjustments".</i> 2. <i>Other items:</i> a. <i>The \$25.00 monthly donations to the ASPCA are recommended for termination as of the date of this order. Other donations, such as the one made to the SLO County Animal Shelter should also terminate, as the estate does not have a sufficient size to donate assets. Petitioner agrees to this change.</i> b. <i>Meals out need to be for the conservatee only, not other parties. It appears Petitioner acknowledges funds will only be used for the conservatee's meals in the future. Meals should be presented in the account by visit, not by adding all the visits up in a month.</i>
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				c. <i>A credit of \$660.00 will appear in the next account, due to overpayment to a dentist and credit by the same.</i> d. <i>“ATM Withdrawals” totaling \$300.00 are noted to be accidental charges and will be reimbursed to the Conservatee. It appears that reimbursement will be in the 11th Account.</i> 3. <i>Bond appears agreeable to remain at \$59,000.</i> 4. <i>The Supplement filed on Sept. 9, 2025 has been reviewed regarding the \$1,600 monthly payment to Petitioner for room and board. It is recommend the Court nunc pro tunc the order signed July 22, 2025 on the Seventh Account, turned in six months after the hearing, to include the order made on February 2, 2025 in open Court approving the increase to \$1,600 a month. It is recommended the increase be effective as of the end of the 10th Account, or January 1, 2026.</i>
<u>HEARING LIST</u>				
4	20PR-0309	Conservatorship of: Robert Brenna	Petition First Year Account; cont'd 9/13/24, 3/14/25, 5/30/25, 9/19/25 and 3/13/26 (SIXTH HRG)	HEARING LIST: <i>Zoom or personal appearance is needed. The Court has continued this matter multiple times, the last time on March 13th to this date, July 17, 2026, at 9:00 a.m. in P2. Additional materials were due by June 1, 2026. An Amended Inventory was filed, with the corrected start date and a new starting balance, but the Amended Account has still not been provided.</i> 1. <i>Accounting issues:</i> a. <i>The account start date should have been from April 23, 2021, the date when the conservatorship was ordered in Court. (See Fiduciary Accounting Handbook</i>

				<i>(Cont.Ed.Bar 2024) When The Accounts of Guardians and Conservators Begin, § 5.4.a.) An amended Account is needed.</i> <i>b. Financial statements have not been located as alleged. (Prob. Code, §2620.)</i> <i>c. Original statements from the care facility located under Schedule C are needed and were not located. (Prob. Code, §2620.) Supporting statements are also needed for those items alleged in the liability schedule, which are not requested for payment from the Conservatorship (Sunrise Terrace and Shiloh Green Manor II).</i> <i>d. Additional information is needed on the \$140,921.51 as alleged liability due to the Petitioner from the conservatorship. A large portion of the itemized costs provided are from a year prior to the appointment and up to six (6) months prior to the filing of this case. Legal authority is needed for payment of the alleged amounts, along with additional information as to why this liability was incurred far before this Court had jurisdiction, in April of 2020. Particular attention should be paid to the following liability requests:</i> <i>i. Original statements are needed from the care facilities, as noted above. The Conservatorship estate is now being asked to pay for the same,</i> <i>ii. Itemized statements are needed from Tardiff Law firm, whose fees are now being requested to be paid by the conservatee.</i> <i>iii. Information is needed on the VCCU credit card.</i>
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				iv. <i>Additional information is needed on the \$3,893.29 in interest incurred on the Discover credit card. Whose name is on the card and why was the credit card not paid off each month? Why was such interest allowed to incur, including over \$500 in interest on pre-paid legal fees paid to the Tardiff Law firm. and items purchased after the conservatorship was established, including but not limited to over \$300 on the bond premium? The practice of putting conservatorship expenses on a credit card, and then over \$3,000 in interest being incurred due to unpaid totals each month on said credit card is very concerning and does not appear to be in line with fiduciary standards.</i> e. <i>A revised schedule describing the change in the form of assets is needed. It is unclear from the materials presented and the current Change in the Form of Asset Schedule, how the total ending shares number and carry value were determined for the three mutual funds on hand</i> 2. <i>Attorney fees:</i> a. <i>The paralegal rate requested exceeds the community standard. A reduction of the fee is recommended in the amount of \$1,417.</i> b. <i>It is recommended the charges related to the “ex parte motion/petition to change venue” be denied. The benefit to the estate for this particular filing is not clear, especially because the conservatee has not returned to</i>
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				<i>Ventura County, but rather, is now in Sonoma County. A reduction of \$2,697.50 is recommended. This does incorporate the reduction of the hourly rate for the paralegal fee noted in 6.a.</i> <i>c. The cost of preparing this account appears high at over \$7,700.00. Additional information is needed to explain the overall process and sum incurred. In addition, specific information is needed on how much time was incurred in preparing the liability schedule and interest schedule related to the Petitioner's current reimbursement request.</i> <i>3. Additional Liability-</i> <i>a. It does not appear the fee due to Attorney Pick, ordered on May 11, 2022, has been paid per the account. This sum was not listed as an outstanding liability. Counsel charged to attend the hearing on 5/6/22, so it appears all parties were aware of the approval.</i> <i>4. The Court Account Review fee of \$305 is due.</i>
5	20PR-0309	Conservatorship of: Robert Brenna	Order to Show Cause re: Second Year Accounting; cont'd 3/14/25, 5/30/25, 9/19/25, 3/13/26	HEARING LIST: <i>The Court has continued this OSC five times. It is unclear why nothing has been filed.</i>
6	20PR-0309	Conservatorship of: Robert Brenna	Order to Show Cause re Sanctions re: failure to respond to probate notes	HEARING LIST: <i>Zoom or personal appearance is required. Sanctions of \$500.00 are recommended for the continued failure to file a meaningful response to the First Account notes or the missing Second and Final Account.</i>
15	20PR-0275	Guardianship of: Krew Sims-Pierce	Petition Filed 10/30/2024 - Confidential Hearing; Cont'd 6/26/25, 8/22/25, 10/24/25 & 2/27/26	HEARING LIST: <i>*UPDATE* Zoom or personal appearance is needed. The parties indicated at the hearing on February 27, 2026 that the matter has settled. This was again noted on July 10, 2026 at the last hearing. The matter was short-set to this hearing date, to accommodate the</i>

				<i>schedule of the Petitioner's attorney. A stipulation was submitted via e-file on July 15, 2026 and is pending review.</i>
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Subject to the rules below, attorneys and parties to a case may now contact the Probate Research Department using the following email: probate@slo.courts.ca.gov.

The following rules apply to use of the foregoing email address. An email that does not comply with the requirements below may not be reviewed.

1. Emails must be related only to a Probate Note (past or present).
 - a. The following exceptions apply: (1) A party or attorney has specifically received an email from the Court on an issue requiring response; or (2) the Court directed an email be sent to the Probate Research Department (Examples: Solicited email from a bench officer or a Court Attorney or information ordered to be provided via email by bench officer in Court).
2. **Emails must contain:**
 - a. **Subject Line: Hearing Date, Time, Department, Case Number and Case Name (Example: 10/1/19, 9:00, D99, 18PR0000, Estate of John Smith).**
 - b. **First Line of Email Body: Case Number, Case Name, and Description of the pleading on the calendar.**
 - c. **Reason for Request.**
 - d. **No Attachments.**
3. Further, email inquiries must conform to the following guidelines:
 - a. Questions must be from an attorney or party on the case.
 - b. The Court's response after the initial reply is limited to one email message per calendar matter, per hearing.
 - c. The body of the email (Reason for Request under item 2.c.) is limited to (5) lines to each deficiency or issue.
 - d. Emails may only inquire into *clarifications* regarding the Probate Note. This includes clarifying language, code sections, court rules and policies related to the Probate Note. Disputes regarding requirements or issues raised in the Probate Note may not be made via email.
 - e. Emails advising the Court of possible oversights may be sent.
 - f. **Continuances may not be requested via the probate email address.**
4. This email procedure is NOT to be utilized for:

- a. Any requests for legal advice (including, but not limited to, how to clear the Probate Note), case management, and/or a recommendation for an attorney.
 - b. Confirmation of documents received by the Court. Please refer to the conformed copy of your filed document to confirm the Court's receipt. If you have not received a conformed copy of your document, please contact the Civil Clerk's Office.
 - c. Confirmation that documents have been reviewed.
5. Response Time. All correspondence will be addressed on a priority basis according to the hearing date. The Probate Research Department will make every effort to respond within two Court days of receipt of the email.